

Horror Puzzle Game

Game Overview

Genre: Horror Puzzle

Engine: Unreal Engine 5

Platform: PC (Windows)

Perspective: First Person

Status: Currently Under Development

Team Size: Solo Developer

Andhkaar (Hindi for "darkness") is a first-person horror puzzle game that combines intricate puzzle mechanics with a suspenseful horror atmosphere. Players must navigate dark, interconnected environments, solve environmental and inventory-based puzzles, and piece together a disturbing narrative — all while managing limited resources and avoiding lurking dangers.

Core Mechanics

Puzzle System

- Environmental puzzles — manipulate objects, levers, and mechanisms in the world
- Logic puzzles — pattern recognition, combination locks, and sequential challenges
- Multi-step puzzles requiring items from different areas
- Puzzle difficulty escalates as the player progresses deeper into the environment

Inventory System

- Grid-based inventory with limited capacity — forces strategic item management
- Item inspection — rotate and examine objects for hidden clues
- Combine items to create new tools or keys
- Key items vs. consumables — different storage priorities

Exploration & Horror

- Non-linear exploration with gated progression through puzzle solving
- Dynamic horror events — scripted and randomized scares
- Limited light sources — flashlight with battery management
- Environmental hazards that require observation and caution

Visual & Atmosphere Design

- **Emissive material effects** for atmospheric, eerie glow on objects and surfaces
- Heavy use of darkness and shadow — the player's flashlight is their primary sight tool

- Volumetric fog and particle effects for environmental depth
 - Custom 3D assets and environment props modeled in **Blender**
 - Color palette: deep blacks, muted teals, and warm amber highlights for contrast
 - Post-processing: film grain, subtle chromatic aberration, and dynamic exposure
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Level Design Philosophy

- Interconnected rooms — shortcuts unlock as puzzles are solved
 - Environmental storytelling through visual details, notes, and object placement
 - Safe rooms for inventory management and narrative exposition
 - Vertical and horizontal exploration with hidden areas
 - Suspenseful pacing — quiet exploration punctuated by horror encounters
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Technical Implementation

Unreal Engine 5

Blueprints

Blender

Inventory System

Puzzle Logic

Emissive Materials

Interaction System

Save/Load

- Modular puzzle framework — puzzle components can be reused and reconfigured
 - Inventory system with UI built entirely in **UMG (Unreal Motion Graphics)**
 - Interactive object system using Blueprint interfaces
 - Save/Load system for persistent game state across sessions
 - Dynamic lighting with baked and real-time shadows for performance balance
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Current Development Status

- ☒ Core puzzle mechanics — implemented
- ☒ Inventory system — implemented
- ☒ Interaction framework — implemented
- ☒ Level design — in progress
- ☒ Horror event scripting — in progress
- ☐ Audio design — planned
- ☐ Final polish & optimization — planned

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